

While you're at it, invest in long-term care insurance for yourself. The younger you start paying into a policy, the better the deal you'll get from the insurance company. A "late starter" might pay premiums up to \$5,000 a year, but the costs are lower the younger you are. For example, if you buy in by age 65, the annual premium averages \$3,017 for men and \$4,838 for women. At 55, you'll be paying in the \$2,000 range, and a 45-year-old gets a real bargain: \$1,230 for men, \$1,912 for women. Those numbers may seem high, but trust me: buying the insurance now is infinitely cheaper than the alternative. When you consider it could cost up to \$96,000 for a one-bedroom suite at a facility in Ontario, \$1,230 a year is a steal.

Remember: *there is a 70 percent chance you're going to need some form of long-term care.* So stop rolling the dice and make a phone call. Your kids will thank you someday.

Money Mistake: Your Parents Don't Have a Plan for Retirement

The Fix: Help Them Set Aside a Critical 10

You shouldn't fund your parents' retirement, but there is no reason you can't help them plan for it. In a recent survey conducted by Harris/Decima for CIBC, nearly half of the people polled (44 percent) said they were not financially ready for retirement, and 53 percent confessed to not having a long-term investment plan. With a little time and effort, you can help ensure that your parents have enough money to see them through their golden years without putting a strain on the financial dynasty you and your partner have built.

Grab a pen and paper and sit down with your mom and dad. Draw a line down the page, dividing it into two columns. Write "Income" on the left-hand side and "Expenses" on the right. In the left column, write down every source of income your parents can rely on in retirement. Include all their pension income and any revenue from investments. Also include income from part-time work, rental properties and provision of services. After you write down each item, ask the following question: *Can this number be*